



Tableau

Become a data 'viz'ard using these Tableau tips and tricks

Dhriti Datta |
dhriti@digit.in

TABLEAU IS ONE OF THE LEADING ANALYTICS PLATFORMS IN THE WORLD that has become a go-to for data visualisations for numerous data analysts across the world. Despite its relatively intuitive interface, some users may have to spend some time practising with the software to master it. As you become more well-versed with the software, you can begin creating high-powered data dashboards and visualisations. In this article, we will outline a few tips and tricks beginners must keep in mind and utilise when working with Tableau to enhance their data visualisations.



CREATE RELATIONSHIPS BETWEEN DATA SOURCES

Tableau allows users to either join or blend their data within the confines of the software itself. To create correlations between different sets of data or data sources, for example – an Excel file and a data pull from Google Analytics – you must blend them based on any common variable between the sources. The process of blending takes place within a sheet in Tableau automatically sometimes. However, if

this doesn't happen, you can facilitate the process by clicking the Blend icon in Tableau. Also, if your data source, say an Excel sheet has multiple tabs that you want to merge together, you can join these tabs in the Data Source tab using Inner Join, Outer Join, Left Join, Right Join and other such features.



AUTOMATE AS YOU GO

If you have to create similar-looking visualisations on a weekly or monthly basis as part of your job, this trick can save you a significant amount of time. So long as you keep your data formatted or pull directly from Google Analytics or other sources, all you need to do is update the data ranges for

it to reflect in your visuals. Want the automation to be even more time-conserving? Take it one step further and create calculated fields that automatically update the data range for you every time additions or changes are made to the source.



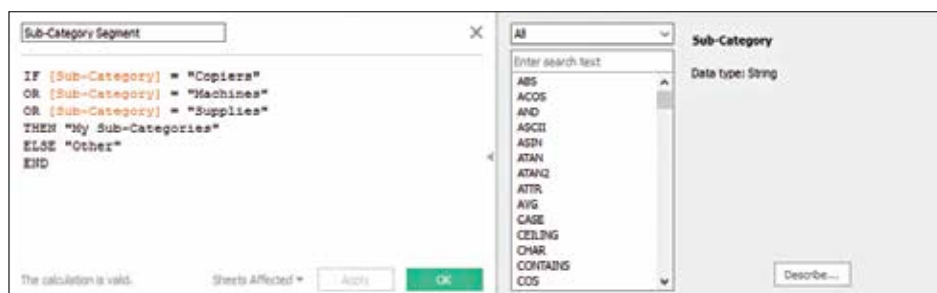
IMPORT CUSTOM COLOUR PALETTES

Tableau comes equipped with colour palettes which users can choose from for their data visualisations. If you want a bit of customisation in the colour palettes, Tableau has you covered. Users can create and use their own custom colour palettes by modifying the Preferences. tps file on Tableau Desktop. In an instance where you don't know the HEX values for the colours you want in your custom palette, you can simply use a colour grabbing tool to input the exact colour you require into Tableau. Custom colour palettes can prove to be extremely useful for when you're tasked by a certain company to create data visualisations for them. You can custom create colour palettes that match the company's brand colours precisely.



USE DASHBOARDS FOR FORMATTING

Tableau makes arranging visuals and legends extremely easy within dashboards, especially if you want to keep your visualisations consistent across different presenta-



Calculated fields can save you a lot of time by automating tasks